

IMO PPR 13 Meeting Summary

24 February 2026



The 13th session of the IMO Sub-Committee on Pollution Prevention and Response (PPR 13) was held 9-13 February 2026 at the IMO Headquarters in London. The meeting was supplemented by hybrid (remote) participation. LISCR participated in the following groups in addition to the plenary.

Group	Subject
WG 1	Working Group on Prevention of Air Pollution from Ships
WG 2	Working Group on Revision of MARPOL Annex IV and Associated Guidelines
WG 3	Working Group on Marine Plastic Litter from Ships
TG1	Technical Group on Evaluation of Safety and Pollution Hazards of Chemicals
DG 1	Drafting Group on Control and Management of Ships' Biofouling

Chemicals

New cargoes and cleaning additives

Under this agenda item, the routine update of chemical substances (new products, cleaning additives, etc.) was examined for release as MEPC.2 Circular after review by the Technical Group on the Evaluation of Safety and Pollution Hazards of Chemicals (ESPH Working Group).

PPR 13 concurred with the work of ESPH 31 and the inclusion of products in MEPC.2/Circ.31, released on 1 December 2025, including:

- The evaluation of pure or technically pure products and mixtures as a whole and their respective inclusion in list 1;
- The evaluation of trade-named mixtures and their respective inclusion in lists 2 and 3, along with consequential additions to list 5; and
- The evaluation of cleaning additives.

PPR 13 also noted the review of the draft MEPC.2/Circ.31 and the amendments and deletion of products that had reached their expiry dates or were no longer shipped.

Persistent floaters

Application of special requirement 16.2.7 (prewash for persistent floaters) to existing cargoes

PPR 13 considered a proposal to assign special requirement 16.2.7 under the IBC Code to 12 solidifying or high-viscosity products frequently associated with residues observed during tank washing operations, and broadly supported their

inclusion based on the criteria in chapter 21 of the IBC Code and the persistent floater designation in the GESAMP Hazard Profile. While concerns were raised regarding the availability of adequate port reception facilities for prewash residues and potential operational and Carbon Intensity Indicator (CII) implications, it was considered that implementation issues should not delay assignment. As a precautionary measure, one product with a wide melting point range was assigned special requirement 16.2.7, with the possibility of future subdivision based on melting point. PPR 13 agreed to add the 12 products to list 1 of the MEPC.2 Circular with special requirement 16.2.7 and decided to review related trade-named mixtures to ensure consistency in future assignments.

Biofouling (in-water cleaning)

Guidance on In-Water Cleaning of Ships' Biofouling

Marine Environment Protection Committee at its 80th session (MEPC 80) adopted the *2023 Guidelines for the control and management of ships' biofouling to minimize the transfer of invasive aquatic species* (resolution MEPC.378(80)) (2023 Biofouling Guidelines). Further, MEPC 83 (2025) approved MEPC.1/Circ.918 on Guidance on in-water cleaning of ships' biofouling (IWC Guidance). PPR worked on development of a legally binding framework for the control and management of ships' biofouling to minimize the transfer of invasive aquatic species.

To PPR 13, 23 documents were submitted, which showed high interest in the subject among governments and industry bodies.

PPR 13 considered the potential form of the legally binding framework and, while some delegations supported amendments to existing instruments such as MARPOL Annex VI, agreed to recommend to MEPC 84 that the framework take the form of a standalone instrument, noting that the benefits of this approach were considered to outweigh those of amending an existing instrument. There was broad support for a stepwise, goal-based and risk-based approach to ensure practicality, implementability and enforceability while retaining flexibility for detailed provisions.

PPR 13 set up the correspondence group (CG) to work intersessionally.

Black carbon

In 2024, the IMO developed resolution MEPC.393(82), *Guidance on Best Practice on Recommendatory Goal-Based Control Measures to Reduce the Impact on The Arctic of Black Carbon Emissions from International Shipping* and resolution MEPC.394(82), *Guidelines on Recommendatory Black Carbon Emission Measurement, Monitoring and Reporting*.

Polar fuel

PPR 13 considered the further development of a possible "polar fuel" measure under MARPOL Annex VI to reduce the impact of Black Carbon emissions from international shipping on the Arctic. PPR 13 noted that a number of delegations supported exploring a fuel-based, technology-neutral approach as an initial step to reduce Black Carbon emissions. However, several delegations recalled that existing and forthcoming measures, including the SO_x and NO_x emission control areas and the prohibition of the use and carriage of heavy fuel oil in Arctic waters under MARPOL Annex I, would already contribute to reducing heavy fuel oil use and associated Black Carbon emissions, and considered that there was insufficient justification at this stage for introducing additional "polar fuel" requirements.

PPR 13 noted divergent views regarding the adequacy of the technical and scientific basis for mandatory measures and the need for further measurement data, as well as observations that fuel quality was not the only factor influencing Black Carbon formation and that operational factors such as engine load were also relevant. It also noted clarifications that the proposed concept would apply only to liquid petroleum-derived fuels and not to gaseous or other low-flashpoint fuels, and considered technical and legal comments aimed at ensuring consistency with existing fuel oil quality provisions, verification procedures and bunker delivery note requirements under MARPOL Annex VI.

Having considered the matter, PPR 13 noted the discussion and agreed to invite interested Member States and international organizations to submit updated or new proposals to PPR 14 on the “polar fuel” concept, taking into account the comments made, in particular with respect to consistency with existing MARPOL Annex VI fuel quality provisions and coherence with existing Arctic measures, including the heavy fuel oil prohibition and established emission control areas.

Exhaust gas cleaning system (EGCS) discharge water

Further work, including legal framework

MEPC had previously adopted the 2021 Guidelines for exhaust gas cleaning systems (resolution MEPC.340(77)) and related 2022 guidance (MEPC.1/Circ.899 and MEPC.1/Circ.900) addressing discharge water assessment and residue delivery to port reception facilities.

PPR 13 continued its consideration of regulatory matters relating to EGCS, including proposals to amend Regulation 4 of MARPOL Annex VI to allow coastal States to restrict EGCS discharge water in Particularly Sensitive Sea Areas (PSSAs). Views were divided. Some delegations supported harmonized IMO action in light of environmental concerns and increasing unilateral restrictions. Others questioned the sufficiency of peer-reviewed scientific evidence, raised legal and procedural concerns regarding compatibility with MARPOL structures, PSSA guidelines and UNCLOS, and cautioned against undermining the existing equivalence framework. Several delegations preferred awaiting the outcome of ongoing GESAMP work before further regulatory development.

In this context, Liberia submitted a document emphasizing that any use of the PSSA mechanism must remain consistent with MARPOL Annex VI amendment procedures and UNCLOS provisions governing navigational rights and coastal State jurisdiction, and cautioned against using PSSAs as a general vehicle for discharge regulation. Liberia also submitted updated peer-reviewed well-to-wake life cycle assessment data comparing marine scrubbers with low-sulphur fuels, confirming previously reported environmental benefits of EGCS and contributing empirical evidence to the broader debate.

As a way forward, the Chair suggested that Member States preparing PSSA applications could assess, on a case-by-case basis, whether an EGCS-related associated protective measure would be relevant within a specific proposal, rather than creating a new PSSA-based mechanism in MARPOL Annex VI. PPR 13 invited intersessional consultations and acknowledged that the target completion date of the output would need to be extended.

EGCS washwater discharge ban – GISIS module

PPR 13 was informed that a new dedicated tab entitled “EGCS Discharge Water Provisions” had been added to the Global Integrated Shipping Information System (GISIS) under the MARPOL Annex VI module to facilitate the submission by Member States of information on local and regional restrictions or conditions relating to EGCS discharge water.

NOx control - compliance

Addressing NOx emissions at low engine load

PPR 13 considered proposals on engine test cycles and weighting factors under MARPOL Annex VI, in response to concerns that NOx emissions at low engine load were higher than anticipated under the existing E2 and E3 test cycles. Many delegations acknowledged that engines frequently operate at low load, including in port areas, and referred to AIS analyses and independent studies suggesting that actual operating profiles differ from those reflected in current test cycles. Some supported introducing a new low-load test point and adjusting weighting factors to better reflect real-world operation, arguing that this would strengthen NOx controls in emission control areas and that technologies such as SCR and thermal management technologies could address low-load performance.

Although there was broad recognition of the issue, views diverged on the regulatory approach. Several delegations questioned whether the data were sufficient to justify revising test cycles, noting uncertainties regarding impacts on fuel consumption, greenhouse gas emissions, costs and administrative burden. Alternatives included maintaining consistency with ISO-based test cycles and introducing a capped NOx value at 10% load within the parent engine test programme. Delegations also emphasized the need for further data on load profiles, consideration of recently adopted not-to-exceed zones (defined engine load and speed ranges subject to a maximum NOx emission limit), and assessment of interactions with EEDI, EEXI and CII.

PPR 13 noted general support for further work but was unable to identify a preferred option. It agreed that intersessional work was needed to analyze implications and develop possible approaches, and invited interested Member States and organizations to submit proposals to a future session.

Enhancing onboard NOx compliance verification and PSC inspections

PPR 13 considered proposals to improve onboard verification methods for NOx compliance and to facilitate inspections, including by port State control inspections. There was broad support for exploring practical mechanisms to demonstrate that engines continue to operate in their certified configuration. Several delegations supported further development of an electronic diagnostic module concept to generate operational reports and enhance inspection efficiency, noting limitations of the current parameter check method for electronically controlled engines and inconsistencies in approaches to monitoring SCR performance. Others cautioned against mandating a specific device, citing technological maturity, calibration challenges and the need to preserve a goal-based and technology-neutral framework. Some delegations favoured retaining the existing system, while updating it to reflect electronically controlled engines, including through the use of checksums or cyclic redundancy checks and additional guidance for crew and port State control officers. PPR 13 was not in a position to identify a preferred approach and agreed that intersessional work by an informal group was needed to develop possible draft requirements and guidance for future consideration.

Development of guidance on SCR operational status and response procedures

PPR 13 considered proposals concerning the determination of SCR operational status and related response procedures, with broad support for developing further guidance to ensure clarity and consistency for ships, crews and Administrations. It was emphasized that such guidance should include reporting requirements in cases of SCR malfunction and should remain technology neutral, covering all NOx control arrangements rather than SCR alone. Concerns were raised that ships

fitted with continuous NOx measurement devices could be disadvantaged compared with those relying on alternative compliance checks, potentially discouraging the use of monitoring technology, and that priority should be given to clarifying compliance determination under the 2025 SCR Guidelines. Interested Member States and international organizations were invited to collaborate intersessionally to develop draft guidelines on NOx reduction strategy failure and associated response procedures for submission to a future session.

NOx control – non-carbon fuels

PPR 13 began consideration of a new output agreed by MEPC to review and amend the NOx Technical Code 2008 (NTC 2008) so that it can properly certify engines operating on non-carbon-containing fuels, such as ammonia, or on mixtures of carbon-containing and non-carbon-containing fuels. The submissions highlighted that the current certification framework was developed primarily for conventional carbon-based fuels and does not fully address the characteristics of emerging alternative fuels. Proposals therefore focused on adapting the calculation and measurement framework for exhaust emissions so that engines using fuels with very different chemical compositions can be certified in a technically sound and consistent manner.

PPR 13 prepared the draft amendments to the NOx Technical Code 2008 to enable certification of engines operating on non-carbon-containing fuels or fuel mixtures. The amendments introduce hydrogen-balance and oxygen-balance methods to complement the existing carbon-balance approach, update relevant chapters and appendices of the Code, and incorporate default u_{gas} coefficient (ratio of exhaust component and exhaust gas densities) for ammonia and hydrogen, with clarification on their applicability to certain fuel mixtures. PPR 13 agreed to forward the draft amendments to MEPC 84 for approval and subsequent adoption.

Sewage

MARPOL Annex IV and associated instruments

In 2019, MEPC 74 instructed PPR to include a revision of MARPOL Annex IV and its associated guidelines to introduce provisions for record-keeping and measures to confirm the lifetime performance of sewage treatment plants (STPs), in addition to the ongoing task of revision of type approval guidelines for Sewage Treatment Plants (STPs).

Sewage record

Regulation 11 (revision) - Discharge of sewage, sewage sludge and effluent

PPR 13 worked on draft amendments to Regulation 11 of MARPOL Annex IV to improve clarity and align the discharge regime with the revised Annex IV framework. While the core discharge distances and conditions remain unchanged, the regulation was restructured and updated to explicitly include sewage sludge and effluent (treated sewage) within the legal discharge provisions.

New Regulation 11A – Mandatory Sewage Record Book

PPR 13 worked on draft Regulation 11A of MARPOL Annex IV introducing a mandatory Sewage Record Book (SRB) for ships to which Annex IV applies. Regulation 11A establishes:

- A requirement to maintain a Sewage Record Book (SRB) onboard;
- The obligation to record each discharge of sewage, sewage sludge and effluent;
- The requirement to record each completed incineration of, or transfer for incineration of, sewage sludge;
- The recording of system failures and other relevant operational events;
- The linkage to Appendix III, which sets out the standardized SRB format.

Provisions relating to indicative monitoring were intentionally left in abeyance pending further development of the broader Annex IV revision.

Appendix III – Introduction of the Sewage Record Book (SRB)

The most significant development at PPR 13 is the introduction of a mandatory Sewage Record Book under Appendix III of MARPOL Annex IV.

At present, Annex IV does not contain a mandatory record book requirement. This represents a major structural expansion of compliance obligations.

The SRB will require ships to record, inter alia:

- discharges of sewage and effluent to sea;
- transfers to reception facilities;
- transfers between tanks;
- incineration or transfer for incineration of sewage sludge;
- system failures;
- certain operational details such as position and speed (where relevant).

Electronic record books will be permitted, subject to Administration approval and alignment with existing IMO electronic record book guidelines.

This brings Annex IV closer in compliance philosophy to Annex I (Oil Record Book), Annex V (Garbage Record Book) and the Ballast Water Convention.

Guidance for recording of operations in the SRB

PPR 13 also approved draft guidance to support the use of the new SRB.

Key elements include:

- Defined discharge categories (sewage, sewage sludge, effluent, comminuted and disinfected sewage, etc.);
- Clarification of when minimum speed and distance-from-land requirements apply;
- Dedicated examples for effluent discharge;
- Recording of sewage system failures, including cases where failures are restored;
- Examples covering transfer of effluent to ballast tanks or to repair facilities;
- A principle that each entry should be recorded under a single designated category.

Provisions related to performance testing and indicative monitoring of STPs remain under further development and were not finalized at this session.

Sewage management plan

PPR 13 worked on draft amendments to MARPOL Annex IV introducing a new Regulation 11B requiring ships to carry a Sewage Management Plan (SMP) approved by the Administration and amendments to the certificate form to insert a tick box for the SMP. This represents a substantive regulatory change, as the current Annex IV does not require an approved SMP. Under the draft text, ships would be required to develop, implement and maintain an Administration-approved SMP addressing procedures for the operation and maintenance of installed sewage systems, management and discharge of sewage, comminuted and disinfected sewage, effluent and sewage sludge, both to sea and to port reception facilities, safety precautions including necessary personal protective equipment, and crew training and familiarization.

PPR 13 also agreed draft guidance for the development of the SMP, aligned with Regulation 11B. References to mandatory approval were removed from the guidance itself, as this requirement is now embedded in the regulation. Provisions related to performance tests and indicative monitoring remain in abeyance pending further development of revised MARPOL Annex IV requirements.

Revision of Type Approval Guidelines for Sewage Treatment Plants

PPR 13 considered draft amendments to the 2012 Guidelines on implementation of effluent standards and performance tests for sewage treatment plants (Type Approval Guidelines), noting differing views on the appropriate base document for further development. However, due to time constraints, the work was tasked to the CG.

Further work on MARPOL Annex IV and re-establishment of the Correspondence Group

PPR 13 was unable, due to time constraints, to consider the remaining draft amendments to MARPOL Annex IV and therefore agreed that a correspondence group should continue the development of the outstanding amendments. PPR 13 agreed to re-establish the Correspondence Group on the revision of MARPOL Annex IV and associated guidelines.

Indicative performance monitoring for existing ships

PPR 13 recalled that draft revisions to MARPOL Annex IV on sewage treatment plants (STPs) currently apply to new installations, and that consideration of extending performance testing and indicative monitoring requirements to existing STPs had been deferred. Any future extension would need to avoid unduly penalizing ships and take into account concerns regarding crew workload, training, technical integration and enforcement. As further development of requirements for new STPs is still ongoing, PPR 13 agreed to keep related submissions in abeyance.

Plastic litter

MEPC 77 had adopted the Strategy to Address Marine Plastic Litter from Ships (resolution MEPC.341(77)). PPR 13 continued its work on plastic litters and MEPC 83 adopted the revised Strategy and the *2025 Action Plan to Address Marine Plastic Litter from Ships* (MEPC.404(83)).

Strategy to address marine plastic litter from ships

PPR 13 agreed to consolidate the existing Strategy and the 2025 Action Plan into a single new MEPC resolution on *2026 Strategy and the Action Plan to Address Marine Plastic Litter from Ships*, for adoption by MEPC 84. The two instruments will remain as separate annexes to the resolution, reflecting their different roles, but will now form one consolidated

framework. Outdated timelines and duplicative tables were removed, and a full review of both the Strategy and the Action Plan was scheduled for 2030 to assess effectiveness and update actions as necessary.

The Strategy sets out the overall objectives, principles and priority areas for addressing marine plastic litter from ships, including implementation of MARPOL Annex V, port reception facilities, enforcement, cooperation and capacity-building. The Action Plan provides the practical implementation roadmap, listing specific actions, responsible actors and time frames to deliver those objectives.

Transport of plastic pellets

Carriage in containers

PPR 13 completed its technical analysis on how to make measures for the carriage of plastic pellets mandatory, but did not reach agreement on which IMO instrument should be amended. PPR 13 sets out three possible regulatory routes for a new mandatory code:

- A new code made mandatory through MARPOL Annex III;
- A new code made mandatory through SOLAS; or
- A single code made mandatory under both MARPOL Annex III and SOLAS.

There was no consensus on a preferred option. The matter will be referred to MEPC 84 for a policy decision on which legal route to pursue.

Carriage in bulk

PPR 13 agreed to forward the document on the carriage of plastic pellets in bulk to the CCC Sub-Committee for further consideration.

Revision of the Integrated Bilge Treatment System (IBTS) guidelines

PPR 13 continued work on formalizing forced evaporation of oily bilge water within the MARPOL Annex I framework, building on draft revisions prepared at PPR 7 in 2020, when the Sub-Committee had developed the 2020 Guidelines for systems for handling oily wastes in machinery spaces of ships incorporating guidance notes for an integrated bilge water treatment system (IBTS), together with related amendments to the IOPP Certificate and Oil Record Book. Although that package had been considered largely complete at the time, MEPC subsequently reopened discussion on the treatment of forced evaporation as a means of reducing the volume of oily bilge water. PPR 13 recalled that MEPC 78 (June 2022) had agreed, in principle, that forced evaporation was acceptable as a treatment method to reduce the volume of oily bilge water and had invited proposals to introduce an appropriate regulation in MARPOL Annex I. At PPR 13, several submissions proposed a new Regulation 12B and consequential amendments to MARPOL Annex I, the IBTS Guidelines and Oil Record Book provisions.

Amendments to MARPOL Annex I

PPR 13 considered proposals to introduce definitions of “integrated bilge water treatment system (IBTS)” and “forced evaporation” in Regulation 1 of MARPOL Annex I but agreed that the detailed definitions should instead be incorporated in the revised IBTS Guidelines, with a footnote in the new draft Regulation 12B referring to those Guidelines. In developing

draft Regulation 12B on forced evaporation, PPR 13 agreed that it should apply to ships of 400 gross tonnage and above fitted with an IBTS, with applicability based on the installation date of the equipment rather than the ship's delivery date, given that IBTS is optional. Certain technical paragraphs initially proposed for inclusion in Regulation 12B were transferred to the revised IBTS Guidelines. PPR 13 developed draft amendments to MARPOL Annex I, including the new Regulation 12B and consequential amendments to the IOPP Certificate and Oil Record Book formats, for submission to MEPC for approval and subsequent adoption.

Draft revised IBTS Guidelines

The draft 2026 IBTS Guidelines are intended to consolidate and supersede the existing guidance contained in MEPC.1/Circ.642, MEPC.1/Circ.676 and MEPC.1/Circ.760, while also incorporating elements previously developed in the draft 2020 IBTS Guidelines prepared at PPR 7 but not finalized. The revised Guidelines maintain the established structure, covering general provisions and definitions; system arrangements for handling oily wastes in machinery spaces; operational and discharge arrangements for oily bilge water; and appendices including guidance notes, a typical IBTS flow diagram and the format of the Statement of Fact on installation. The revisions align the guidance with the new draft Regulation 12B on forced evaporation, clarify definitions and service tank arrangements, refine heating provisions, and update recording and certification aspects while preserving the overall framework.

PPR 13 introduced formal definitions of “integrated bilge water treatment system (IBTS)”, “forced evaporation” and “oily bilge water service tank”, using a referencing approach consistent with MARPOL Annex I. Structural amendments were made to improve clarity, including relocation and renumbering of provisions relating to sludge treatment and regeneration, and the addition of a dedicated paragraph on the oily bilge water service tank. In relation to sludge service tanks, the PPR 13 retained the existing regulatory references while incorporating options for heating to facilitate gravitational settling and forced evaporation, and clarified that such tanks count toward total sludge retention capacity.

Operational provisions were refined, particularly concerning discharge arrangements and the use of 15 ppm bilge alarms. To avoid unintended design constraints, the text now refers to “a 15 ppm bilge alarm”, allowing either the existing alarm or an additional unit, depending on ship design. Heating arrangements were carefully reviewed to avoid retroactive or overly prescriptive effects: the proposed maximum design temperature of 60°C was retained without creating a mandatory interpretation, while the maximum temperature for oily bilge water in the service tank was increased from 100°C to 105°C to support effective evaporation. A new paragraph on forced evaporation was included to ensure that such arrangements prevent leakage and adverse impacts on other equipment. The typical IBTS flow diagram was updated primarily in the oily bilge water section, with consequential adjustments to the sludge section, and the format of the Statement of Fact on installation of an IBTS was revised accordingly. After determining that certain proposed new paragraphs were duplicative, the PPR 13 developed the draft 2026 IBTS Guidelines and the associated draft MEPC circular for submission to MEPC for approval alongside the MARPOL Annex I amendments.

Draft revised Oil Record Book (ORB) Guidance

The draft revised Guidance for recording of operations in the Oil Record Book (ORB) Part I was updated in conjunction with the development of draft Regulation 12B and the revised IBTS Guidelines. PPR 13 reviewed the draft text originally prepared at PPR 7 and introduced targeted amendments to ensure consistency with the new regulatory framework for integrated bilge water treatment systems (IBTS) and forced evaporation. In particular, example #10-1 concerning the bilge separation unit was deleted, and three new examples were inserted: examples #12bis and #13bis under code D to reflect,

respectively, the transfer of bilge water to a clean bilge holding tank through 15 ppm equipment and the disposal of bilge water by forced evaporation; and example #20bis under code I to clarify the recording of overboard discharge of clean bilge water from a clean bilge holding tank through a 15 ppm bilge alarm. These revisions aim to provide clearer and more practical recording instructions aligned with the updated IBTS arrangements and discharge pathways. The finalized draft revised ORB Guidance and associated draft MEPC circular were forwarded for approval by MEPC 84 in conjunction with approval and subsequent adoption of the related MARPOL Annex I amendments.

Unified interpretation

Shipboard incinerator

MARPOL Annex VI requires that shipboard incinerators be designed so that the combustion temperature reaches 600°C within five minutes of start-up. At PPR 13, it was clarified that this is a design approval requirement to be verified during type approval testing. It is not an operational performance requirement to be checked during normal onboard use. In other words, the 600°C requirement applies to how the incinerator is designed and certified. The onboard temperature monitoring system is intended to support safe operation and continuous compliance, but it is not used to demonstrate compliance with the design requirement, since actual onboard conditions may differ from those during type approval testing. Accordingly, PPR 13 developed a draft unified interpretation for approval by MEPC 84.

Application date for a major conversion in relation to an emission control area

Application criteria for new ships under Regulation 13 of MARPOL Annex VI (NO_x control) were historically based solely on the keel-laying date. However, the Norwegian Sea Emission Control Area (ECA) and the proposed North-East Atlantic ECA used three date criteria commonly applied elsewhere in the MARPOL Convention, namely the building contract date, the keel-laying date, or the delivery date. As the existing interpretation of the application of the regulation in cases of major conversion was based only on a single date criterion, namely the keel-laying date, PPR 13 developed a new interpretation for these ECAs for approval by MEPC 84 to reflect this point.

Any other business

Ammonia effluent management from ammonia-fuelled ships

PPR 13 considered the new post-biennial output agreed by MEPC 83 on the development of guidelines for managing ammonia effluent generated from ammonia-fuelled ships, taking into account proposals and comments submitted, and supporting information documents. PPR 13 noted broad recognition of ammonia as a potential alternative marine fuel and the associated need to address effluent management, while emphasizing that any future work should be science-based and supported by operational data and empirical evidence, which are currently limited. Diverging views were expressed, with some delegations supporting a conditional discharge framework based on risk assessments and specific operational criteria, and others advocating prohibition of ammonia-effluent discharge in line with the precautionary principle, particularly given concerns regarding chronic toxicity, reactive nitrogen release, and impacts on vulnerable States such as small island developing States (SIDS). PPR 13 invited Member States and international organizations to submit further proposals to PPR 14 and agreed to forward the relevant documents for further consideration.

Volatile organic compounds (VOC) emissions

PPR 13 considered further work on the reduction of volatile organic compounds (VOC) emissions, recalling that MEPC had approved a scope of work and that SSE 11 had concluded that a minimum 0.20 bar opening pressure for pressure/vacuum (P/V) valves would not have negative safety implications. A Member State proposed draft amendments to Regulation 15 of MARPOL Annex VI and related changes to the IAPP Certificate to require new crude oil tankers to be fitted with P/V valves with a minimum opening pressure of 0.20 bar to reduce VOC emissions.

Accordingly, PPR 13 developed draft amendments to Regulation 15 of MARPOL Annex VI, together with consequential amendments to the Form of the International Air Pollution Prevention (IAPP) Certificate (appendix I), with a view to approval by MEPC 84 and subsequent adoption.

Further information

For further information, please contact: imo@liscr.com

Annex

Provisional list of draft circular/resolution/Convention/Code

- Draft amendments to the NOx Technical Code 2008 on non-carbon fuels
- 2026 Strategy and the Action Plan to Address Marine Plastic Litter from Ships
- Draft MEPC Circular on implementation of fishing gear marking systems
- Draft amendments to MARPOL Annex I, including the new regulation 12B and consequential amendments to the IOPP Certificate and Oil Record Book formats in relation to Integrated Bilge Treatment Systems (IBTS)
- Draft 2026 Integrated Bilge Treatment Systems (IBTS) Guideline
- Draft revised Oil Record Book (ORB) Guidance in relation to Integrated Bilge Treatment Systems (IBTS)
- Draft unified interpretation on shipboard incinerator
- Draft unified interpretation on NOx control at a major conversion in relation to an emission control area
- Draft amendments to regulation 15 of MARPOL Annex VI, together with consequential amendments to the Form of the International Air Pollution Prevention (IAPP) Certificate (appendix I) in relation to control of Volatile organic compounds (VOC) emissions